

Linping Zhang

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MSc Banking and Digital Finance candidate at UCL with experience in financial data analysis, automated analytical workflows and data-driven modelling. Skilled in working with structured datasets and translating financial and technical outputs into clear, decision-relevant insights.

EDUCATION

MSc Banking and Digital Finance — University College London (UCL) *Sep 2025 – Sep 2026 (expected)*
BSc Finance — Nanjing Agricultural University (NAU) *Sep 2021 – Jun 2025*
GPA: 90.42/100 (3.85/4.5) — Top 13% of cohort

FINANCIAL DATA & ANALYTICS PROJECTS — UCL

- AI-Driven Equity Research Agent — NVIDIA** — Individual project — full build | *Intro to Financial Markets*
- Independently developed a Python-based equity-research workflow integrating financial and market data from Alpha Vantage and yfinance, with JSON caching to reduce API-rate-limit dependence and support reproducible analysis.
 - Built a modular analysis workflow covering data ingestion, financial-ratio calculation, valuation and automated reporting; integrated GPT-4o to generate structured investment narratives grounded strictly in pre-computed quantitative outputs.
- Financial Data & Systematic Equity Platform** — Group project — technical documentation | *Big Data in Quantitative Finance*
- Reviewed ETL, database and backtesting workflows across PostgreSQL, MongoDB and MinIO, cross-checking project documentation against implementation logic and clarifying technical methodology with the development team.
 - Authored technical and methodology documentation translating database, portfolio-construction and backtesting workflows into clear, reproducible reporting; documented a five-year strategy evaluation achieving a 0.871 Sharpe ratio vs. 0.569 for MSCI World.
- Transformer-Based Credit Default Prediction** — Group project — architecture design | *Finance & AI*
- Designed a Feature-as-Token Transformer in PyTorch for credit-card default prediction on an imbalanced 30,000-customer dataset, modelling cross-variable interactions across credit limits, repayment status and payment behaviour.
 - Evaluated model performance through controlled ablation experiments, achieving a 0.7814 test ROC-AUC versus 0.7821 for a tuned Random Forest, while delivering higher recall and highlighting the trade-off between missed defaults and false-positive reviews.
- LSTM Equity Trading Strategy Replication** — Independent project — full ownership | *Financial Analytics & ML*
- Independently built and evaluated an LSTM-based equity strategy in Python across multiple market regimes, controlling for look-ahead bias and realistic transaction costs.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

- Equity Research Assistant** — Huachuang Securities — Consumer/Liquor Sector *Sep 2024 – Jan 2025*
- Researched global spirits markets across the US, Europe and Asia using PEST analysis, contributing to two industry analysis reports; independently analysed the fundamentals, market positioning and ownership structure of six listed companies, supporting ongoing coverage of 13 listed firms.
 - Maintained structured industry datasets and produced five market-tracking reports, consolidating company, sales and market information into reusable research inputs.
- Audit Intern** — KPMG — Audit Department *Jan 2025*
- Reconciled audit-report figures against underlying financial records across two client engagements, validating data consistency across ledgers, contracts, invoices and bank receipts.
- Finance & Audit Assistant** — Shandong Qirun Accounting Firm *Jan 2024 – Feb 2024*
- Reviewed accounting vouchers and prepared ledgers and financial statements for 10 SME clients, supporting tax reconciliation and audit procedures under reporting deadlines.

SKILLS & ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

Analytics: Financial Data Analysis, Data Reconciliation, Model Evaluation, Technical Documentation

Technical: Python (pandas, scikit-learn, PyTorch; project-based), SQL (basic), Excel

Data & Platforms: Alpha Vantage, yfinance, Bloomberg Terminal (basic), Wind, Choice Data

Languages: Mandarin (Native), English (Professional working proficiency)

Awards & Leadership: Merit Student Scholarship; 3rd Prize, 10th ERP Sand Table Simulation Competition (Team Leader); Deputy Minister, Elite Accountants Association (NAU).